בס"ד

Introduction to Vocabulary and Language Skills

for the Zekelman Standards for Chumash

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by Rabbi Y. Rosenblum and Mrs. S. Rosenfeld

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Nouns

NOUNS are the type of words which describe things, including people, places, objects and ideas. Examples of nouns are chair, boy, Chaim, and Texas. A noun in Hebrew is called a **שם עצם**.

1. Circle all the nouns.
   a. ball
   b. run
   c. Dovid
   d. boy

2. Underline the nouns in the sentences below.
   a. Chaim ran to shul.
   b. Dovid ate cookies and chips.
   c. The family drove to New York.

3. Circle all the nouns.
   a. אברם
   b. אמר
   c. ארץ
   d. ברא

4. A noun in Hebrew is called a:___
   a. שרש
   b. פעל
   c. שם עצם

5. Write five nouns.

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____

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In Hebrew all nouns are either זכר or נקבה. Generally, a noun which ends with ָה or ת is נקבה like the word לבנה or דלת. All other nouns are זכר like יום. Most Hebrew nouns are זכר.

1. A noun in Hebrew is called _____ _____.

2. Circle all the nouns
   a. car
   b. toy
   c. sing
   d. Shmuel

3. Circle all the nouns.
   a. מטה
   b. יום
   c. לחם

4. Draw a circle around all the words that are זכר, and a square around all the words that are נקבה.
   a. מטה
   b. יום
   c. לחם
   d. שבת

5. A word which ends with a _____ is נקבה.
   a. ה or ת
   b. ים
   c. ָה or ת

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In English to change a noun from singular to plural you add an *s.* For example: boy, boys; book, books; cup, cups. In Hebrew to change a noun from singular to plural you add ִים or ות depending on whether the noun is זכר or נקבה .

	ילד One boy	**יחיד**
הָ or **ת**	ילדה One girl	יחידה
ִים	ילדים 2 or more boys	רבים
ות	ילדות 2 or more girls	רבות

1. Circle the nouns which are plural.
   a. salads
   b. car
   c. shoes
   d. runs

2. A plural noun which ends with a _____ is נקבה.
   a. ה or ת
   b. **ים**
   c. **ות**

3. A plural noun which ends with a _____ is זכר.
   a. ה or ת
   b. **ים**
   c. **ות**

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4. Circle the nouns which are plural.

   a. חמרים

   b. ארץ

   c. שפחות

5. Circle the nouns which are plural in זכר.

   a. חמרים

   b. ארץ

   c. שפחות

6. For each word, make a check in the correct column to show whether it is יחיד, יחידה, רבים or רבות.

	יחיד	יחידה	רבים	רבות
איש				
ילדה				
ילדים				
שפחות				

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Adjectives

Adjectives are words that describe another person or thing in the sentence.

The **big** book

The **tall** boy

The **pretty** picture

In each case the adjective describes the noun. What kind of book? What kind of boy? What kind of picture?

1. Circle the adjectives.
   a. big
   b. small
   c. car
   d. house
   e. tall

2. Circle the nouns and underline the adjective in each sentence;
   a. The short horse.
   b. The nice house
   c. The smart teacher
   d. The fancy computer

3. Fill in the blank with one of the adjectives from the word bank:
   a. A _____ car.
   b. A _____ boy.
   c. The _____ desk.
   d. A _____ pencil.
   e. The _____ door.

   Word Bank: Front, Brown, Sharp, Clean, Tall

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In לשון קודש an adjective is called a **שם תואר**. Some common ones are גדול, ארוך, קטן, טוב, חזק.

There are two big differences between an adjective in Hebrew and one in English. In English the adjective is said or written before the noun it describes. In לשון קודש it is nearly always the other way around.

For example when you say, a big boy, the adjective **big** is said or written before the noun (**boy)** that it describes. The same sentence in לשון קודש would be ילד גדול. The noun ילד is first and then the adjective גדול comes second. That is one of the reasons why it does not always make sense when you translate a פסוק from לשון קודש directly to English in the same word order.

The other big difference is that in English the adjective stays the same regardless of the noun it describes. 'Big' will stay the same in each of these descriptions; the **big** boy, the **big** girl, the **big** boys, the **big** girls. In לשון קודש the adjective changes to match the noun depending on whether it is זכר or נקבה and יחיד or רבים. The adjective usually has the same ending (suffix) as the noun it is describing.

	יחיד	**רבים**
זכר	ילד גדול	**ילדים גדולים**
נקבה	ילד**ה** גדול**ה**	**ילדות גדולות**

1. A noun in Hebrew is called a:___
   a. **שם עצם**
   b. **פעל**
   c. **שם תואר**

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2. An adjective in Hebrew is called a:___

   a. שרש

   b. פעל

   c. שם תואר

3. Circle the adjectives.

   a. בית

   b. גדול

   c. ילד

   d. קטן

4. Circle the nouns and underline the adjective.

   a. ילדה קטנה

   b. איש חכם

   c. בית גדול

5. Circle the adjective and underline the noun that it describes.

כָּבֵד הָרָעָב

כִּי–יָפָה הִוא

נִגְעִים גְּדֹלִים

וְאַבְרָם, כָּבֵד מְאֹד, בַּמִּקְנֶה, בַּכֶּסֶף וּבַזָּהָב.

כִּי–הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב

וְאַנְשֵׁי סְדֹם, רָעִים וְחַטָּאִים

אָנֹכִי מָגֵן לָךְ––שְׂכָרְךָ, הַרְבֵּה

חֲשֵׁכָה גְדֹלָה

בִּרְכֵשׁ גָּדוֹל

וְהִנֵּה תַנּוּר עָשָׁן

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6. Look at each phrase and decide if it is זכר or נקבה and יחיד or רבים. Write the correct word in each box. Then see if the noun and adjective match and write Yes or No in the last column.

Do they match Yes or No	Adjective רבים or יחיד	Noun רבים or יחיד	Adjective נקבה or זכר	Noun נקבה or זכר	
					וַיִּקַּח בֶּן-בָּקָר רַךְ וָטוֹב
					וַאדֹנִי זָקֵן
					יָמִים רַבִּים
					וְהוּא עָיֵף
					וְיַעֲקֹב אִישׁ תָּם
					וַיֵּצֵא הָרִאשׁוֹן אַדְמוֹנִי

The סמיכות Form

In English one way of saying that one noun belongs to another noun is by using the words “a” or “the” and “of”.

For example, if we would say “a book of the boy” or “the book of the boy” we would mean by this that a book or the specific book belongs to the boy.

In לשון קודש, however, we do not need the words “a” or “of”. Sometimes we don’t even need the word “the”. Simply by putting two nouns side by side we get the meaning “a _____ of _____” OR “the _____ of _____”.

1. Translate each of the phrases in סמיכות on the line provided:

Group 1:

a. קוֹל יַעֲקֹב _____

b. סוּס פרעה _____

c. מֶלֶך ישראל _____

Group 2:

a. מַלְכֵי ישראל _____

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b. בְּנֵי יעקב _____

Group 3:

a. זַעֲקַת סדום _____

b. אֵשֶׁת אברהם _____

Group 4:

a. נְהַר פרת _____

b. דְבַר ה׳ _____

Group 5:

a. מְטַר ארצך _____

b. כְּתֹנֶת בְּנִי _____

Group 6:

a. בֶּן זְקוּנִים _____

b. כָּל ישראל _____

c. כְּתֹנֶת פַּסִים _____

Group 7:

a. כְּתֹנֶת הַפַּסִים _____

b. שְׁלוֹם הַצֹּאן _____

c. בַּעַל הַחֲלוֹמות _____

2. What is the significant feature that is unique to each of the seven groups? Write this feature in the space next to each group number above.

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טעמי המקרא – "Trop"

A ספר תורה has no punctuation. Part of our מסורה and what משה רבינו taught בני ישראל, was how to read the תורה correctly. This included how to pronounce the words and how to 'sing' the words (as in when a בעל קורא reads the תורה in shul).

At first this was passed down orally from generation to generation. Now, in our printed חומשים, we see this מסורה through two main items – the נקודות and the טעמי המקרא.

The טעמי המקרא serve three important functions:

1. They tell us how to sing the words and the **פסוקים**.
2. They tell us which part of the word needs to be emphasized. The **טעמים** are written on the accented syllable of the word.
3. They tell us where to stop, or pause and take a breath (related to number 1) which indicates how to break up the **פסוק**.

"Punctuation" in a פסוק

In English, the three most common punctuation marks are the full stop, the comma and the question mark.

What is the equivalent to these in the Chumash?

דרגה שם	הסימן	מקומו בפסוק, בחולית, וצירופיו
קיסרים		
1. סוֹף־פָּסוּק:	ס:	
2. אתנח / אתנחתא	ת	

Full Stop (Period):

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When you read a פסוק, and you stop only at the אתנחתא, you will have two full sentences in the verse.

Try it!

א וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב בְּאֶרֶץ מְגוּרֵי אָבִיו בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן׃ ב אֵלֶּה ׀ תּוֹלְדוֹת יַעֲקֹב יוֹסֵף
בֶּן־שְׁבַע־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה הָיָה רֹעֶה אֶת־אֶחָיו בַּצֹּאן וְהוּא נַעַר אֶת־בְּנֵי בִלְהָה וְאֶת־בְּנֵי
זִלְפָּה נְשֵׁי אָבִיו וַיָּבֵא יוֹסֵף אֶת־דִּבָּתָם רָעָה אֶל־אֲבִיהֶם׃ ג וְיִשְׂרָאֵל אָהַב אֶת־יוֹסֵף
מִכָּל־בָּנָיו כִּי־בֶן־זְקֻנִים הוּא לוֹ וְעָשָׂה לוֹ כְּתֹנֶת פַּסִּים׃ ד וַיִּרְאוּ אֶחָיו כִּי־אֹתוֹ אָהַב
אֲבִיהֶם מִכָּל־אֶחָיו וַיִּשְׂנְאוּ אֹתוֹ וְלֹא יָכְלוּ דַּבְּרוֹ לְשָׁלֹם׃ (בראשית ל"ז)

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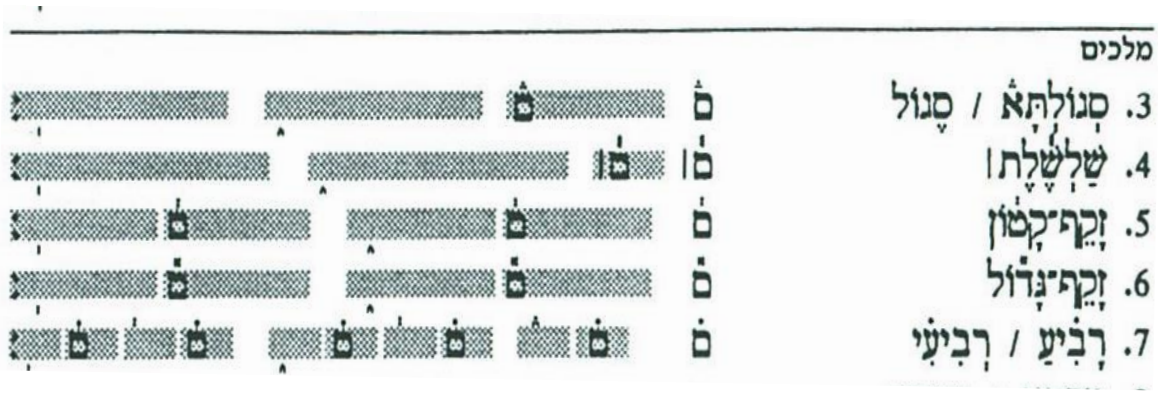
Comma:

If I need to break up a פסוק further, the comma will appear either in between the beginning of the פסוק and the אתנחתא or between the אתנחתא and the end (סוף פסוק).



Try it!

א וַיֵּשֶׁב יַעֲקֹב בְּאֶרֶץ מְגוּרֵי אָבִיו בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן׃ ב אֵלֶּה ׀ תּוֹלְדוֹת יַעֲקֹב יוֹסֵף בֶּן־שְׁבַע־עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה הָיָה רֹעֶה אֶת־אֶחָיו בַּצֹּאן וְהוּא נַעַר אֶת־בְּנֵי בִלְהָה וְאֶת־בְּנֵי זִלְפָּה נְשֵׁי אָבִיו וַיָּבֵא יוֹסֵף אֶת־דִּבָּתָם רָעָה אֶל־אֲבִיהֶם׃ ג וְיִשְׂרָאֵל אָהַב אֶת־יוֹסֵף מִכָּל־בָּנָיו כִּי־בֶן־זְקֻנִים הוּא לוֹ וְעָשָׂה לוֹ כְּתֹנֶת פַּסִּים׃ ד וַיִּרְאוּ אֶחָיו כִּי־אֹתוֹ אָהַב אֲבִיהֶם מִכָּל־אֶחָיו וַיִּשְׂנְאוּ אֹתוֹ וְלֹא יָכְלוּ דַּבְּרוֹ לְשָׁלֹם׃ (בראשית ל"ז)

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Conjunctions, Prepositions and Other Grammatical Items

The Letters

Of the 22 letters of the א-ב, 11 of them serve other functions. They are: א, ב, ה, ו, י, כ, ל, מ, נ, ש, ת. To remember this easily you can think: איתן משה וכלב.

The letter 'ו:

The letter 'ו, at the beginning of a word, can be used for two different functions

1. ו' החיבור - The word AND. In לשון קודש it is not a separate word, the letter 'ו is attached to the beginning of the word. The normal ניקוד would be a שוא as in אברהם וְיצחק וְיעקב.

2. ו' ההיפוך – The reversing 'ו (or 'ו consecutive) is when the 'ו appears before a verb, past or future and changes the tense.

Questions:

1. Which of the following letters serve another function?
   a. צ
   b. ק
   c. ו

2. Which letter before a word sometimes switches the word from future to past?
   a. ה
   b. א
   c. ו

3. What is the regular ניקוד for the ו' החיבור?____

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4. Circle the ו' החיבור in the following words.

משה וְאהרן

5. Which of the following sometimes switches the word from future to past?

   a. The ו' החיבור

   b. The ו' ההיפוך

   c. The letters איתן משה וכלב

ה' הידיעה – DEFINITE ARTICLE ה'

Articles in English are very important, as we use them all the time. The three articles in English are **a**, an, and the. Here are some basic rules for understanding how to use these articles:

The is the **definite article**. It is used before nouns that are *specific* or *particular*. Here are some examples:

Can we go to **the** park? The park is specific. It is known to the speaker and the listener.

"**The** president is a busy man." There is only one president, so we are referring to a *specific* noun here.

A/an are the **indefinite articles**. We use a/an before *general, non-specific* nouns

Can we go to **a** park? The park is unspecific. The speaker doesn't care which one.

In לשון קודש there is no indefinite article, but there is a definite article. The definite article is written with the letter ה'. It is attached to the noun and cannot stand by itself.

The definite article ה usually has a פתח under it and a דגש in the next letter. Therefore ילד is 'a boy', while הַיֶּלֶד is 'the boy'. מלך is 'a king', while הַמֶּלֶךְ is 'the king'.

1. Fill in either: **a, an,** or **the.**

   a. There was a plate with three peanut butter cookies and one chocolate chip cookie. I

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took _____chocolate chip cookie.

b. There was a plate with five chocolate chip cookies. I took ____ chocolate chip cookie.

2. Circle the words which are articles.

a. In

b. An

c. But

d. The

e. A

3. Circle the words which are indefinite articles.

a. In

b. An

c. But

d. The

e. A

4. Circle the word which is a definite article.

a. In

b. An

c. But

d. The

e. A

5. If I want to say, “the house” which letter would I add to the word בית?___

6. Which ניקוד does the definite article ה usually have?____

7. Circle the ה׳ הידיעה and underline the ו׳ החיבור.

8. בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ

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Prepositions

A preposition is a part of speech, just like a noun or a verb. It connects a noun or pronoun to another word in the sentence, showing us the relationship between them. Prepositions usually answer the questions where? or when?, telling us about a person or object's location in either time or space. There are over 150 prepositions. The following are some of them: after, as, at, before, following, for, from, in, like, near, on, over, past, since, to.

1. Circle the words which are prepositions.
    a. from
    b. went
    c. ran
    d. To
    e. house

2. Use one of the prepositions from the word bank to fill in each of the blanks.

Dovid went _____ Chaim ____ the store _____ the street_____ recess.

Preposition Word Bank: to, across, with, during

Hebrew Prepositions

The following are some Hebrew prepositions: עִם, אל, אחר, אצל, אל, בין, כמו, עד, בתוך

The Letters ב, כ, ל,

These three letters are inseparable prepositions. In other words they are used as prepositions but are attached to the word. Their basic ניקוד is a שוא. If the

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preposition is before a word with the definite article ה', the ה' will drop and the letters ב, כ, ל will take on the ניקוד of the definite article ה'.

For example:

בְּבַיִת means “in a house”.

בַּבַּיִת means “in the house”.

The Letter מ

The letter מ is short for the word מן and is a prepositional prefix. The basic ניקוד is חיריק under the מ' and a דגש in the next letter.

For example: מִפֹּה but מֵעִם (since you cannot put a דגש in the letter ע').

1. Circle the letter which means, in.

   יהי מאורות ברקיע השמים

2. Circle the letter which means, with.

   ואחרי כן יצאו ברכש גדול

3. Circle the letter which means, when.

   בשבתך בביתך

4. Circle the letter which means, in

   בשבתך בביתך

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5. Match the prefixes with the correct translation.

In, with	ו
Like, when	ה
That	ב
To	כ
The	ל
And	מ
From	ש

6. Match the word on the left to the correct definition on the right.

Nouns	Describing words
Adjectives	Action words
Verbs	Naming words

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Pronouns

Pronouns are words such as *he*, *she*, *they*, and *it*. They can replace nouns in a sentence.

Sholom wants to learn how to read the Megilla.

He practices every day.

To avoid repeating *Sholom* in the second sentence, the pronoun *he* can be used.

1. Read the sentences and use one of the pronouns from the word bank to complete each sentence.
   a. Dovid likes recess. _____likes recess
   b. The car belongs to Shmuel. He owns_____
   c. I own this bicycle. The bicycle belongs to_____
   d. Eli and Dov cleaned up the mess. _____ cleaned up the mess.

Word Bank: it, me, he, they

1. Draw a circle around all nouns, and a square around all the pronouns.
   a. It
   b. Daniel
   c. They
   d. He
   e. Car

2. A pronoun is a word that we use instead of a _____.
   a. Noun
   b. Adjective
   c. Verb

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Referent of Pronoun

For every pronoun, we need to figure out who or what is it talking about.

Sholom wants to learn how to read the Megilla, so he practices every day. "He" refers to Sholom.

1. "Moishy came home from school. He went to the kitchen for a snack." Who is "he"?

2. "Shira loves to play ball. She also loves playing tag." Who is "she"?

3. "Chava and Sarale are studying together." What can I say instead of "Chava and Sarale?"___

   a. He

   a. She

   b. They

4. "Mendel, Yitzi and I are going to play." What can I say instead of "Mendel, Yitzi and I?"___

   a. He

   b. They

   c. We

Subjects and Objects

Most English sentences have a subject, a verb and an object. The subject is the person or thing doing the action (the verb) in the sentence. The object is the person or thing receiving the action. For example: "Chaim threw the book". Chaim is doing the action. Chaim is the subject. The book is what he threw, the book is the object.

Most sentences in לשון קודש also have a subject, verb and an object. Most pronouns in English (aside from 'it' and 'you') and all pronouns in לשון קודש will change depending on whether the noun they are replacing is the subject or the object of a sentence.

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For example in the sentence: “I spoke to her”, “I” is the pronoun for the subject, and “her” is the pronoun for the object. You would not say, “Me spoke to she”.

We call these two types of pronouns a subjective pronoun if it replaces the subject of the sentence, and an objective pronoun if it replaces the object of the sentence.

Subjective Pronouns	Objective Pronouns
I	me
You	you
We	us
He	him
She	her
It	it
They	them

Subjective Pronouns– לשון קודש

M=Masculine F=Feminine S=Singular P=Plural	
I	אֲנִי
You (M)	אַתָּה
You (F)	אַתְּ
He/It (M)	הוּא
She/It (F)	הִיא
We	אֲנַחְנוּ
You (M)	אַתֶּם

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You (F)	אַתֶּן
They (M)	הֵם
They (F)	הֵן

1. Draw a line from the Hebrew pronoun to the matching English pronoun.

He/It (M)	אֲנִי
She/It (F)	אַתָּה
You (F)	אַתְּ
You (M)	הוּא
I	הִיא

2. Draw a line from the Hebrew pronoun to the matching English pronoun.

They (M)	אֲנַחְנוּ
They (F)	אַתֶּם
You (F)	אַתֶּן
You (M)	הֵם
We	הֵן

3. In the following פסוק, circle the pronoun that replaces the noun אברהם.

וַיַּעַל אַבְרָם מִמִּצְרַיִם הוּא וְאִשְׁתּוֹ

4. Circle the pronoun in the following פסוקים and write the translation above the word.

צֵא מִן הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּבָנֶיךָ:

וְהִנֵּה אֲנַחְנוּ מְאַלְּמִים אֲלֻמִּים בְּתוֹךְ הַשָּׂדֶה

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Objective Pronouns– לשון קודש

M=Masculine F=Feminine S=Singular P=Plural	
Me (M,F,S)	אוֹתִי
You (M,S)	אוֹתְךָ
You (F,S)	אוֹתָךְ
Him/It (S)	אוֹתוֹ
Her/It (F)	אוֹתָהּ
Us (M,F,P)	אוֹתָנוּ
You (M,P)	אֶתְכֶם (אוֹתְכֶם)
You (F,P)	אֶתְכֶן (אוֹתְכֶן)
Them (M,P)	אוֹתָם (אֶתְהֶם)
Them (F,P)	אוֹתָן (אֶתְהֶן)

1. Draw a line from the Hebrew objective pronoun to the matching English pronoun.

Him/It (M)	**אוֹתִי**
Her/It (F)	אוֹתְךָ
You (M)	אוֹתָךְ
You (F)	אוֹתוֹ
Me	אוֹתָהּ

2. Draw a line from the Hebrew objective pronoun to the matching English pronoun.

Them (M)	**אוֹתָנוּ**
Them (F)	אֶתְכֶם (אוֹתְכֶם)
You (F)	אֶתְכֶן (אוֹתְכֶן)
You (M)	אוֹתָם (אֶתְהֶם)
Us	אוֹתָן (אֶתְהֶן)

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3. In the following פסוק, circle the objective pronoun that replaces the noun יוסף.

וַיֵּלֶךְ יוֹסֵף אַחַר אֶחָיו ... וַיִּרְאוּ אֹתוֹ מֵרָחֹק

4. In the following פסוק, circle the objective pronoun that replaces the noun אבן.

וַיִּקַּח אֶת־הָאֶבֶן אֲשֶׁר־שָׂם מְרַאֲשֹׁתָיו וַיָּשֶׂם אֹתָהּ מַצֵּבָה׃

5. Circle the objective pronoun in the following פסוקים and write the translation above the word.

הַשְׁלִיכוּ אֹתוֹ אֶל־הַבּוֹר הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר בַּמִּדְבָּר

וְלֹא־חָשַׂךְ מִמֶּנִּי מְאוּמָה כִּי אִם־אוֹתָךְ

Possesive Nouns and Pronouns

A possessive noun tells us who (or what) owns or has something. Possessives answer the question "Whose?"
To make a singular word possessive in English, just add the letter s.

Chaim = Chaim's car

The car = The car's front seat

Mine, **yours**, **his**, **hers**, **its**, ours, theirs are possessive pronouns used in the place of a noun and to show possession or ownership.

- I saw <u>his</u> book on <u>your</u> table.
- <u>My</u> house is small.
- <u>Our</u> house is big.

1. Circle the possessive pronouns.
   a. I
   b. Mine
   c. You

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d. His

e. Theirs

2. Circle the possessive nouns.

a. You

b. Shmuel's

c. Her

d. Car's

3. Read the sentences and use one of the possessive pronouns from the word bank to complete each sentence.

a. The toy belongs to us. The toy is_____.

b. I own this book. The book is _____.

c. Sara and Chani made the cookies. The cookies are_____.

Word Bank: theirs, mine, ours

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Hebrew Possessive Pronouns

M=Masculine F=Feminine S=Singular P=Plural	
Mine (M,F,S)	שֶׁלִּי
Yours (M,S)	שֶׁלְּךָ
Yours (F,S)	שֶׁלָּךְ
His (S)	שֶׁלּוֹ
Hers (S)	שֶׁלָּהּ
Ours (M,F,P)	שֶׁלָּנוּ
Yours (M,P)	שֶׁלָּכֶם
Yours (F, P)	שֶׁלָּכֶן
Theirs (M,P)	שֶׁלָּהֶם
Theirs (F,P)	שֶׁלָּהֶן

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1. Draw a line from the Hebrew possessive pronoun to the matching English possessive pronoun.

Yours (F, P)	שֶׁלָּנוּ
Ours (M,F,P)	שֶׁלָּכֶם
Yours (M,P)	שֶׁלָּכֶן
Theirs (F,P)	שֶׁלָּהֶם
Theirs (M,P)	שֶׁלָּהֶן

2. Draw a line from the Hebrew possessive pronoun to the matching English possessive pronoun.

His (S)	שֶׁלִּי
Hers (S)	שֶׁלְּךָ
Mine (M,F,S)	שֶׁלָּךְ
Yours (F,S)	שֶׁלּוֹ
Yours (M,S)	שֶׁלָּהּ

3. Circle the possessive pronouns.
   a. הם
   b. אנחנו
   c. שֶׁלָּכֶם
   d. אני
   e. שֶׁלָּנוּ
   f. שֶׁלְּךָ

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Possesive Suffix

In Chumash the possessive pronouns are usually replaced by suffixes. A possessive suffix is a suffix of a noun which tells us who is in possession of the noun.

HEBREW POSSESSIVE PRONOUN SUFFIXES		
M=Masculine F=Feminine S=Singular P=Plural		
Mine (M,F,S)	ִי	שֶׁל -י
Yours (M,S)	ךָ	שֶׁל-ךָ
Yours (F,S)	ךְ	שֶׁלָּ -ךְ
His (S)	ו	שֶׁל -ו
Hers (S)	ָהּ	שֶׁלָּ-הּ
Ours (M,F,P)	נוּ	שֶׁלָּ-נוּ
Yours (M,P)	כֶם	שֶׁלָּ-כֶם
Yours (F, P)	כֶן	שֶׁלָּ-כֶן
Theirs (M,P)	ָם	שֶׁלָּ-הֶם
Theirs (F,P)	ָן	שֶׁלָּ-הֶן

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SINGULAR MASCULINE NOUNS WITH A POSSESSIVE SUFFIX		
נקבה	**זכר**	*Possessive Pronoun*
סִפְּרִ-י	סִפְּרִ-י	שֶׁלִּ -י
	סִפְּרְ-ךָ	שֶׁל-ךָ
***סִפְּרֵ-ךְ**		שֶׁלָּ -ךְ
	סִפְּר-ו	שֶׁל -ו
סִפְּרָ-ה		שֶׁלָּ-הּ
סִפְּרֵ-נו	סִפְּרֵ-נו	שֶׁלָּ-נו
	סִפְּרְ-כֶם	שֶׁלָּ-כֶם
סִפְּרְ-כֶן		שֶׁלָּ-כֶן
	סִפְּרָ-ם	שֶׁלָּ-הֶם
סִפְּרָ-ן		שֶׁלָּ-הֶן

*Note the change in **ניקוד** from the pronoun. A **צירה** replaces the **קמץ**.

**Note also, we have put dashes into the words to help highlight the suffixes and how they match the pronoun. They are NOT syllable divisions and the words are not normally written this way.

PLURAL MASCULINE NOUNS WITH A POSSESSIVE SUFFIX		
נקבה	**זכר**	
סִפָּרַ-י	סִפָּרַ-י	שֶׁלִּ -י
	סִפָּרֶ-יךָ	שֶׁל-ךָ
סִפָּרַ-יךְ		שֶׁלָּ -ךְ
	סִפָּרָ-יו	שֶׁל -ו
סִפָּרֶ-יהָ		שֶׁלָּ-הּ
סִפָּרֵ-ינו	סִפָּרֵ-ינו	שֶׁלָּ-נו
	סִפָּרֵ-יכֶם	שֶׁלָּ-כֶם
סִפָּרֵ-יכֶן		שֶׁלָּ-כֶן
	סִפָּרֵ-יהֶם	שֶׁלָּ-הֶם
סִפָּרֵ-יהֶן		שֶׁלָּ-הֶן

**Note also, we have put dashes into the words to help highlight the suffixes and how they match the pronoun. They are NOT syllable divisions and the words are not normally written this way.

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1. In the following *psukim*, underline the nouns with possessive suffixes.

a. לֹא כֵן עַבְדִּי מֹשֶׁה בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא:

b. וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם אֶל עַבְדּוֹ זְקַן בֵּיתוֹ

c. וַתֹּאמֶר שְׁתֵה אֲדֹנִי וַתְּמַהֵר וַתֹּרֶד כַּדָּהּ עַל יָדָהּ וַתַּשְׁקֵהוּ:

2. Draw a line from the Hebrew pronoun to the matching words in the other column.

עֵינָיו	עֶבֶד שֶׁלְּךָ
בְּנִי	רַגְלַיִם שֶׁלָּכֶם
רַגְלֵיכֶם	עֵינַיִם שֶׁלּוֹ
עַבְדְּךָ	בֶּן שֶׁלִּי

3. Fill in the missing word from the word bank:

a. עִמּוֹ = עַם _____

b. בֵּיתְךָ = בַּיִת _____

c. יָדִי = יָד_____

d. בִּגְדָהּ = בֶּגֶד_____

Word Bank: שֶׁלּוֹ , שֶׁלִּי, שֶׁלְּךָ, שֶׁלָּהּ

4. Fill in the missing word:

a. עִמּוֹ = עַם _____

b. בֵּיתְךָ = בַּיִת _____

c. יָדִי = יָד_____

d. בִּגְדָהּ = בֶּגֶד_____

5. Fill in the missing word:

a. עִמּוֹ = _____ _____

b. בֵּיתְךָ = _____ _____

c. יָדִי = _____ _____

d. בִּגְדָהּ = _____ _____

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Pronoun	יחיד (עבד של_____)	יחידה (שפחה של_____)	רבים (עבדים של_____)	רבות (שפחות של____)
שֶׁלִּי	ִי (עַבְדִּי)	**תִּי** (שִׁפְחָתִי)	**ַי** (עֲבָדַי)	תַּי **(שִׁפְחוֹתַי)**
שֶׁלָּנוּ	**נוּ** (עַבְדֵּנוּ)	**תֵּנוּ** (שִׁפְחָתֵנוּ)	**ֵינוּ** (עֲבָדֵינוּ)	תֵּינוּ **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵינוּ)**
שֶׁלּוֹ	**וֹ** (עַבְדּוֹ)	**תּוֹ** (שִׁפְחָתוֹ)	**ָיו** (עֲבָדָיו)	תָּיו **(שִׁפְחוֹתָיו)**
שֶׁלָּהּ	**ָהּ** (עַבְדָּהּ)	**תָּהּ** (שִׁפְחָתָהּ)	**ָי-הָ** (עֲבָדֶי-הָ)	תֵּי-הָ **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵי-הָ)**
שֶׁלְּךָ	**ךָ** (עַבְדְּךָ)	**תְּךָ** (שִׁפְחָתְךָ)	**ֶיךָ** (עֲבָדֶיךָ)	תֶּיךָ **(שִׁפְחוֹתֶיךָ)**
שֶׁלָּךְ	**ךְ** (עַבְדֵּךְ)	**תֵּךְ** (שִׁפְחָתֵךְ)	**ַיִךְ** (עֲבָדַיִךְ)	תַּיִךְ **(שִׁפְחוֹתַיִךְ)**
שֶׁלָּכֶם	**כֶם** (עַבְדְּכֶם)	**תְּכֶם** (שִׁפְחַתְכֶם)	**ֵיכֶם** (עַבְדֵיכֶם)	תֵּיכֶם **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵיכֶם)**
שֶׁלָּכֶן	**כֶן** (עַבְדְּכֶן)	**תְּכֶן** (שִׁפְחַתְכֶן)	**ֵיכֶן** (עַבְדֵיכֶן)	תֵּיכֶן **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵיכֶן)**
שֶׁלָּהֶם	**ָם** (עַבְדָּם)	**תָּם** (שִׁפְחָתָם)	**ֵיהֶן** (עַבְדֵיהֶן)	תֵּיהֶם **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵיהֶם)**
שֶׁלָּהֶן	**ָן** (עַבְדָּן)	**תָּן** (שִׁפְחָתָן)	**ֵיהֶן** (עַבְדֵיהֶן)	תֵּיהֶן **(שִׁפְחוֹתֵיהֶן)**

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Verbs

A verb is a word that expresses an action or an occurrence. It is usually one of the main parts of a sentence. Eat, sleep, walk, and jump are all examples of verbs. In Hebrew a verb is called a פועל. In the example "Yaakov ate a sandwich", the word ate is a verb, it tells us what Yaakov did. Objects can also be described by actions. The car is **running**. The ball is **flying.**

1. Circle the verb:
   a. ball
   b. run
   c. Dovid
   d. Boy
2. Circle the word that is **not** a verb
   a. Went
   b. Ask
   c. Door
   d. Think
3. Circle the word that is a noun
   a. Clean
   b. Find
   c. Man
   d. Send
4. Circle the noun and underline the verb in the following sentences
   a. Milk is good to drink.
   b. I am a girl.
   c. I brush my teeth.
   d. Close the window, please
   e. It is time to daven minchah.
5. Circle the word that is **not** a verb
   a. אוכל

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b. הולך

c. רץ

d. ילד

6. Circle the noun and underline the verb in the following phrases.

a. וַיֹּאמֶר ה׳

b. וַיֵּרֶד אַבְרָם

c. וַיְהִי–לוֹ צֹאן–וּבָקָר

d. וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ, לֹא–תִקַּח אִשָּׁה מִבְּנוֹת כְּנָעַן

7. Complete the sentence from the choices presented.

a. A noun in Hebrew is called a:___

b. A root in Hebrew is called a:___

c. A verb in Hebrew is called a:___

שם עצם ;פועל ; שרש

Roots - שרשים

The שרש is the root of a verb. The שרש of a verb has 3 letters and should be written with a period between each letter. It cannot be pronounced. In לשון קודש, as soon as you pronounce it, you are saying that it happened at a particular time (past, present, future etc) by a particular kind of person or thing (masculine or feminine, singular or plural) and in a particular way (simply, strongly, causing someone else to do it and more).

Since a verb is called a פעל, we refer to the first letter of the root as the פ' הפועל, the second letter as the ע' הפועל and the third letter as the ל' הפועל.

For the root ש.מ.ר. the letter ש is the פ' הפועל the letter מ' is the ע' הפועל and the letter ר' is the ל' הפועל.

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Knowing a שרש will help you translate many words with that שרש. For example א.כ.ל. is a שרש and we know it means "eat", therefore if you see the word ותאכלנו you may not know what the word means but by finding the three letter שרש you

Present Tense Verbs:

Many שרשים can be changed to a present tense (simple) verb by simply adding the letter "ו" between the first and second root letter.

א.כ.ל. becomes אוֹכֵל

ה.ל.כ. becomes הוֹלֵךְ

know it has something to do with eating.

1. Change the following words into the basic verb – **פועל** – present tense form.
   a. **א.ה.ב.** _____
   b. **ש.מ.ר.** _____
   c. **ז.כ.ר.** _____
   d. **כ.ת.ב.** _____
   e. **ל.ב.ש.** _____

Like nouns, present tense verbs in Hebrew are either זכר or נקבה. And, like nouns, present tense verbs which end with ָה or ת are נקבה.

Like nouns, to change present tense verbs in Hebrew from singular to plural you add ִים or וֹת depending on whether the verb is זכר or נקבה . Nouns and verbs need to match in a sentence.

The verb and the noun (the action and the person/object doing the action) need to "agree" in gender – נקבה\זכר and number רבים\יחיד .

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Please note that when you have a group of words including both זכר and נקבה nouns or even many נקבה and only one זכר noun, we use the זכר form for the verb.

This is different from in English. In English it does not make a difference who is doing the action or how many are doing it.

The boy is **washing** his face.

The girl is **washing** her face.

The boys are **washing** their faces.

The girls are **washing** their faces.

In each of these examples the verb "washing" is the same whether a boy or a girl or many people are doing the action.

To use our sample words from before;

נקבה – רבים Girl - Plural	**זכר רבים** Boy - Plural	**נקבה – יחיד** Girl - Singular	**זכר – יחיד** Boy - Singular	**פ.ע.ל.** root
אוה**ב**ות	אוה**ב**ים	אוה**ב**ת	אוה**ב**	א.ה.ב.
שו**מ**רות	שו**מ**רים	שו**מ**רת	שו**מ**ר	ש.מ.ר.
זו**כ**רות	זו**כ**רים	זו**כ**רת	זו**כ**ר	ז.כ.ר.
כו**ת**בות	כו**ת**בים	כו**ת**בת	כו**ת**ב	כ.ת.ב
לו**ב**שות	לו**ב**שים	לו**ב**שת	לו**ב**ש	ל.ב.ש.

1. Conjugate the verb into present tense according to the pronoun or noun/s given.

a. **את** (נ.ת.נ.) _____

b. **הם** (ש.ב.ר.) _____

c. **הוא** (ג.מ.ר.) _____

d. **אברהם ושרה** (נ.פ.ל.) _____

e. **אבא** (ע.ז.ר.) _____

f. **שלחנות** (ע.מ.ד.) _____

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In all of the previous examples, all the letters of the שורש can be seen in the verb that was created. We call these roots שלֵמים – "complete" because the complete שורש remains in the word.

However, some שורשים have "weak" letters that drop out of the verb depending on its form (בנין) and tense or due to added prefixes or suffixes. The letters that commonly drop out are the letters י.ו.נ.ה.

An easy way to remember this is to think יונה פרח – "a dove flew away".

These שורשים are called חסרים – "missing" – because letters of the שורש are often missing when the verb is formed.

For example, any שורש that has a 'ו or a 'י as the middle letter will only have two letters in the present (and past) tense.

The root ק.ו.מ. becomes קָם

The root ב.ו.א. becomes בָּא

The root ש.י.ם. becomes שָׂם

The root ש.י.ר. becomes שָׂר

Future Tense Verbs:

The Future Verb Tense is when you talk about doing something later, in the future. It could be in seconds, in hours, or in centuries.

In English the simplest and most common way of changing the present (now) to the future (later) is by adding "will" before the verb.

For example; "I am eating an apple" becomes "I **will** eat an apple". "They are going to the park" becomes "They **will** go to the park". Objects can also 'do' things in the future. It **will** rain. The car **will** need more gas.

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1. Look at the following sentences mark it with a **P** if it is in the Present Tense or an **F** if it is in the Future Tense.
   a. We are eating breakfast in the Succah. _____
   b. It will be Succos soon. _____
   c. Hopefully it will not rain during Succos. _____
   d. We are buying a Lulav and Esrog set for Succos. _____
   e. We are not planning on sleeping in the Sukkah. _____

In לשון קודש, to change from the Present to the Future you will need to add a prefix (a letter before) or a suffix (a letter after) or both to the שורש פ.ע.ל. What letter is added will depend on whether the verb is זכר or נקבה and יחיד or רבים. The future tense of the verb will also change if it is גוף ראשון, שני, שלישי – first, second, or third person.

גוף ראשון -First person is when you are talking about yourself (אני, אנחנו); גוף שני – second person is when talking to someone (אתה,את,אתם,אתן); גוף שלישי – third person is when talking about someone (הוא,היא,הם,הן).

The letters added to all future tense verbs, in all forms, are the letters איתן.

Therefore it would look like this

	יחיד			**רבים**	
גוף	זכר	נקבה		זכר	**נקבה**
ראשון	**א** פ.ע.ל.	**א** פ.ע.ל.		**נ** פ.ע.ל.	נ **פ.ע.ל.**
שני	**ת** פ.ע.ל.	**ת** פ.ע.ל. **י**		**ת** פ.ע.ל. **ו**	ת **פ.ע.ל.** נה
שלישי	**י** פ.ע.ל.	**ת** פ.ע.ל.		**י** פ.ע.ל. ו	ת **פ.ע.ל.** נה

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For example:

	יחיד			רבים	
גוף	זכר	נקבה		זכר	**נקבה**
ראשון	א למד	א למד		נ ל מַד	**נ למַד**
שני	תִּ למד	תִּ למד י		תִּ למד ו	**תִּ למד נה**
שלישי	י למד	תִּ למד		י למד ו	**תִּ למד נה**

1. Fill in the blanks using the chart above as a guide.

	יחיד			רבים	
גוף	זכר	נקבה		זכר	**נקבה**
ראשון					**נ גמר**
שני		ת גמר י		תִּ גמר ו	
שלישי	י גמר				

2. Look at the following words and write if it is Present or Future tense.

a. אוכלים _____

b. אזכר _____

c. אהבות _____

d. יחשבו _____

e. תכתב _____

f. בוחרות _____

g. תלבשנה _____

h. תעזרו _____

i. קונה _____

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3. Fill in the boxes in each column based on the choices given at the top of the column. Choose the choice that best describes the verb given on the right.

	גוף ראשון/ שני /שלישי	יחיד/רבים	זכר/נקבה
נאהב			
תלמדו			
תאסף			
יאכל			
אלבש			
תאמרנה			

4. Fill in the correct subjective pronoun to match the verb.

_____אֲגַדְּלָה _____ תֵּלֶד _____ תֹּאכְלוּ

_____ יֵצֵא _____ אֶעֱשֶׂה _____ תִּזְרַע

_____ תֹּאמַר _____ תֵּלֵךְ _____ תַּעֲבִירוּ

_____ אֶקַּח _____ נוֹכַל _____ נֶאֱסֹף

_____ יֹאכְלוּ _____ יִקְחוּ _____ תָּשֵׁבוּ

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In English, the Past Tense is used to describe that happened in the past. The most common way of changing a verb from present to the past is by adding the letters ***ed*** to the root of the verb. For example walk becomes walk**ed**, push becomes push**ed**, and watch becomes watch**ed**. It does not make the difference what or who the noun or pronoun is. One boy walked, three girls walked, we walked, or the dog walked the verb is always the same.

1. Look at the following verbs and change them from the present to the past.
   a. Greet _____
   b. Work _____
   c. Free _____
   d. Call _____
   e. Wash _____

There are also verbs that do not follow this pattern. They are called irregular verbs. Some common verbs that are irregular include:

Buy	bought
Go	went
Eat	ate
Do	did
Run	ran

1. Look at the list of words, if they are Past tense mark them with a P, if they are Present mark them with a T.
   a. Play _____
   b. Shopped _____
   c. Walk _____
   d. Ran _____
   e. Called _____

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In לשון קודש, and especially in חומש, there are two ways to recognize a verb in the Past Tense. The most common way found in the חומש is when you see the "וַ". The "וַ" when added to the Future tense of the word changes it to the Past tense. For example, a word like וַיֹּאמֶר the last three letters אמֶר is the שרש of the word (א.מ.ר. say) the י is the prefix that tells that it is זכר and גוף שלישי and in the future. The וַ at the very beginning changes the Future to the Past. Therefore the word does not mean "and he **will** say" but "and he sa**id**".

A verb in the past tense can also be recognized by the special suffixes that are added only to past tense verbs. These letters are always one or more of the letters תהימון.

What suffix is added will depend on whether the verb is זכר or נקבה and if it is יחיד or רבים. The past tense of the verb will change if it is גוף ראשון, שני, שלישי – first, second, or third person. In other words, if you are talking about yourself – first person, גוף ראשון; talking to someone – second person, גוף שני; or talking about someone – third person, גוף שלישי.

This is very similar to how the root changed to the future tense form but it is the suffix that is telling you that you are in the past tense (instead of the prefix in the future tense).

Therefore it would look like this

	יחיד			רבים	
גוף	זכר	נקבה		זכר	**נקבה**
ראשון	פ.ע.ל.**תִּי**	פ.ע.ל. **תִּי**		פ.ע.ל.**נוּ**	**פ.ע.ל.** נוּ
שני	פ.ע.ל. **תָּ**	פ.ע.ל. **תְּ**		פ.ע.ל. **תֶּם**	**פ.ע.ל.** תֶּן
שלישי	פ.ע.ל.	פ.ע.ל□.**ה**		פ.ע.ל. **ו**◌	**פ.ע.ל.** וּ

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Used with a regular verb like שמר it would look like this:

	יחיד			רבים	
גוף	זכר	נקבה		זכר	**נקבה**
ראשון	שמר**תִּי**	שמר**תִּי**		שמר**נו**	**שמרנוּ**
שני	שמר**תָּ**	שמר**תְּ**		שמר**תֶּם**	**שמרתֶּן**
שלישי	שמר	שמר**ה**		שמר**ו**	**שמרו**

1. Fill in the boxes in each column based on the choices given at the top of the column. Choose the choice that best describes the verb given on the right.

	גוף **ראשון/ שני /שלישי**	**יחיד/רבים**	**זכר/נקבה**
אספתי			
למדה			
אמרנו			
אהבתן			
לבשת			
אכלו			

2. Fill in the correct subjective pronoun to match the verb.

_____ גדלתי	_____ הלכתן	_____ שאלנו
_____ אכלתם	_____ שמרת	_____ אכלתן
_____ אמרה	_____ בדקנו	_____ עבר
_____ קחו	_____ יכלו	_____ שמרו
_____ עשה	_____ לקחת	_____ ישבתי

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Tense Past – Present - Future	Subjective Pronoun	שרש Root	
			וַיִּקְרָא
			תֹּאכְלוּ
			וַיָּבֹאוּ
			וַיְהַלְלוּ
			אכלתן
			תַּעֲבִירוּ
			וַתֵּצַח
			אמר□ה
			וַיְשַׁלְּחוּ
			אַרְאֶךָ
			אוכלים
			אספתי
			וְאֶעֱשֹׂךְ
			תָּבֹאוּ
			לבשת□
			וַיִּבְחַר
			אוהבות
			וַיָּבֹא
			וַתֹּאמֶר
			אֶשְׁמֹר
			עשה
			וַתֹּאמַרְנָה
			יושב
			קונה
			תֵּלֶד
			למדה
			יִקְחוּ
			תִּקְנֶה

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נקודות and דגשים

The following section, explaining the rules of the נקודות and דגשים as seen in our holy תורה, will help you to better understand nearly all ניקוד variation you may come across in relation to prefixes, accents on words and the verb forms in particular בנינים.נְקוּדוֹת

The dots (נקודות) that are written above or below letters are called תְּנוּעוֹת. This word, coming from the root 'movement', implies that the תנועות allow the sound of the letter and thus the word to move on.

There are ten תנועות. Five are תְּנוּעוֹת גְּדוֹלוֹת (long vowels) and five are תְּנוּעוֹת קְטַנוֹת (short vowels).

תְּנוּעוֹת גְּדוֹלוֹת			תְּנוּעוֹת קְטַנוֹת	
1) ָ קָמַץ	דָּבָר		6) ַ פַּתָּח	סַל
2) ֵ צֵירֶה	אֵם		7) ֶ סֶגוֹל	בֶּגֶד
3) ִי חִירִק מָלֵא	עִיר		8) ִ חִירִק חָסֵר	כִּבְשָׂה
4) וֹ חוֹלָם מָלֵא-חָסֵר	קוֹל-דֹּב		9) ָ קָמַץ קָטָן	אָזְנַיִם
5) וּ שׁוּרֵק	סוּס		10) ֻ קִבּוּץ	שֻׁלְחָן

A תְּנוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה is considered a long vowel because it takes longer to say and as such causes one to spend more time on the syllable. Therefore, a letter with a תְּנוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה becomes a syllable in its own right. A תְּנוּעָה קְטַנָה is considered a short vowel. It is used when we need to say that part of the word more quickly. Therefore, when a letter has a תְּנוּעָה קְטַנָה it must have support. It cannot be a syllable on its own. Support comes in various ways as we will learn very soon.

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The vowels work in pairs. At times, when a תְּנוּעָה קְטַנָּה cannot be used in a word, its 'partner' תְּנוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה is used instead. Each pair of vowels appear on the same row in the table above.

In general, the קָמַץ קָטָן, although it looks like a regular קָמַץ, only appears as a replacement of the חוֹלָם חָסֵר when faster movement is needed e.g in the plural form of the word of when the word appears as part of סְמִיכוּת (construct chain).

For example: חֹדֶשׁ becomes חָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה

אֹזֶן becomes אָזְנַיִם

כֹּל becomes כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

The שְׁוָא

Two dots standing vertically on top of each other (ְ) under a letter is a sign that the letter does not have a תְּנוּעָה. This sign is called a שְׁוָא.

A שְׁוָא is NOT A תְּנוּעָה!

There are two types of שְׁוָאִים: A שְׁוָא נָע and a שְׁוָא נָח.

These names indicate their roles.

שְׁוָא נָע

The word נָע means 'moves'. This שוא moves the word on. It is always found at the beginning of a syllable and it starts the syllable with a quick vowel like sound. Often in סידורים, this שוא is marked in some way to tell the person to pronounce it.

For example: שָׁמְרוּ divided into syllables is שָׁ-מְרוּ

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שְׁוָא נָח

The word נָח means 'rests'. This שוא also ends a syllable and is silent.

For example: תִּכְתְּבוּ divided into syllables is תִּכְ-תְּבוּ. The first שוא is a שוא נח; it ends the first syllable and is silent. The second שוא is a שוא נע; it begins the second syllable with a quick sound.

Rules of the שוא נע

It is easier to remember the rules using the letters of the א-ב.

א- A שוא under the **first** letter of a word is a שוא נע.

דְּבָרִים שְׁמַע

ב- If there are two שואים in the middle of a word, the **2nd** is a שוא נע.

יִשְׁמְרוּ

ג- A שוא that comes after a letter with a תנועה גדולה is aשוא נע.

כָּתְבָה תֵּשְׁבוּ

ד- A שוא under a letter with a דָגֵשׁ is a שוא נע.

מְלַמְּדִים דִּבְּרוּ

ה- A שוא under the first of two of the same letter is a שוא נע.

הִנְּנִי הַלְּלוּ

In general, if it does not meet the criteria of the שוא נע it is a שוא נח!

Remember: you can never have consecutive שואים נעים in a word.

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The שוא נח

It is not always necessary to review all the rules of a שוא נע to decide if a שוא is a נע or a נח. There are three rules by which we can immediately recognize a שוא נח.

Rules of the שוא נח

1. A **שוא** at the end of a word is always a **שוא נח**.

   הָלַךְ מֶלֶךְ

2. If there are two **שואים** at the end of a word, they are both **שואים נחים**.

   אָמַרְתְּ וַיֵּבְךְ

3. If there are two **שואים** in the middle of the word, the 1st is a **שוא נח**.

   יִשְׁמְרוּ יִכְתְּבוּ

4. A **שוא** after a **תנועה קטנה** is usually a **שוא נח**.

   שִׁמְשׁוֹן תִּסְגֹּר

Explanation:

Sometimes, you may see words that seem to contradict rule #4 (that the שוא after a תנועה קטנה is a שוא נח). In these cases, the תנועה קטנה has the accent of the word. This makes the syllable longer and has the same effect as a תנועה גדולה. Thus, it is a syllable in its own right and the שוא following is a שוא נע.

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שְׁוָא מוּרְכָּב

The letters ע ח ה א are called guttural letters (אותיות גרוניות). These letters are difficult to pronounce with a שוע נע. Therefore, in words where these letters should have a שוא נע, we add a vowel to the שוא to make it easier to sound the syllable. This type of שוא is called a שוא מורכב and it has all the rules of a שוא נע.

You know these vowels by the names חֲטָף סֶגוֹל, חֲטָף פַּתָּח, חֲטָף קָמַץ

For example: דֶּרֶךְ becomes דְּרָכִים but אֶרֶץ becomes אֲרָצוֹת

קֶבֶר becomes קְבָרִים but חֶדֶר becomes חֲדָרִים.

דָּגֵשׁ

The dot inside a letter is called a דגש.

There are three type of דְּגֵשִׁים: דָּגֵשׁ קַל and דָּגֵשׁ חָזָק and a מַפִּיק.

דגש קל

A דגש קל can only appear in the letters בגד כפת (often referred to as בֶּגֶד כֶּפֶת) and only under two conditions:

בגד כפת at the beginning of a word.

בגד כפת after a שוא נח (thus beginning a new syllable)

These letters are pronounced differently with or without a דגש. We hear this difference clearly in the letters ב,כ,פ,ת. The letters ג and ד were also originally pronounced differently. The תֵּימָנִים still pronounce this difference.

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There are times when you may see a word that seems to have a שוא נח (since it follows a תנועה קטנה), but there is no דגש in the בגד כפת letters following it.

Explanation:

We learned that you cannot have consecutive שואים נעים in a word. Thus there are times when, if two שואים should have been at the beginning of a word, the first שוא changes to a תנועה which we call a תנועה קלה (a light vowel) and the second שוא is called a שוא מרחף (hovering שוא). This שוא does not act as a normal שוא נח and does not affect the letters בגד כפת. They remain 'soft' (without a דגש) just as if the שוא was a שוא נע. For example: the word: מַלְכֵי should have been מְלָכֵי therefore the שוא under the מ became a פתח and the שוא under the ל is a שוא מרחף and does not cause the letter כ to get a דגש. The same applies to the word עִזְבוּ derived from the word עָזַב or עַנְפֵי from the word עֲנָפִים.

דגש חזק

A דגש חזק comes in all letters (including בג"ד כפ"ת) but excluding the gutturals (א, ה, ח, ע) and the letter ר'.

In other words you will never find a דגש of any kind in the letters "רֵעַ הָאָח" and you will find both types of דגשים in the letters בגד כפת.

A דגש חזק comes only after a תנועה קטנה.

What is the role of the דגש חזק?

The דגש חזק, as the name implies, give strength in some way.

As you noticed earlier, a letter with a תנועה קטנה cannot be a syllable on its own. It needs support in some way. A דגש חזק in the next letter is one way of giving that

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support. The purpose of this דגש is, in effect, to double the letter in which it is found to give support to the previous syllable with a תנועה קטנה.

For example:

Take the word שִׁנַּנְתָּם. Logic dictates that the syllables of this word are שִׁ-נַנְ-תָּם. However, we then have a תנועה קטנה under the ש as a syllable by itself. We therefore see a דגש חזק in the first נ. This doubles the נ so the syllables look like this: שִׁנְ- נַנְ-תָּם.

Note: the דגש in the ת is a דגש קל (בגד כפת after a שוא נח) and therefore does **not** double the letter.

Here are some more examples:

הַמִּתְנַשֵּׂא = הַמְ-מִתְ-נַשְׂ-שֵׂא

מִמִּשְׁפַּחְתּוֹ = מִמְ-מִשְׁ-פַּחְ-תּוֹ

When the letter after a תנועה קטנה is a guttural, we cannot put a דגש into it. In these cases two things can happen:

The תנועה קטנה can change to its 'partner' תנועה גדולה e.g אֵלֵּם but חֵרֵשׁ. We call this change a "תַּשְׁלוּם דָּגֵשׁ".

The תנועה קטנה remains as it is. This happens particularly with the letters ע,ח,ה. E.g. בִּעֵר, מַהֵר, מִחוּט.

מפיק

The מפיק only appears in the letter ה at the end of the word. We do not call this a דגש. The מפיק signifies that we are referring to 'her' or 'hers.' For example: דּוֹדָהּ means דוֹד שֶׁלָּהּ – 'her uncle;' שָׁמְרָהּ is short for שָׁמַר אוֹתָהּ – 'he guarded her;' לָהּ – 'to her.'

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